Becoming an Agentic Scrum Master

Handing my boring work to agents

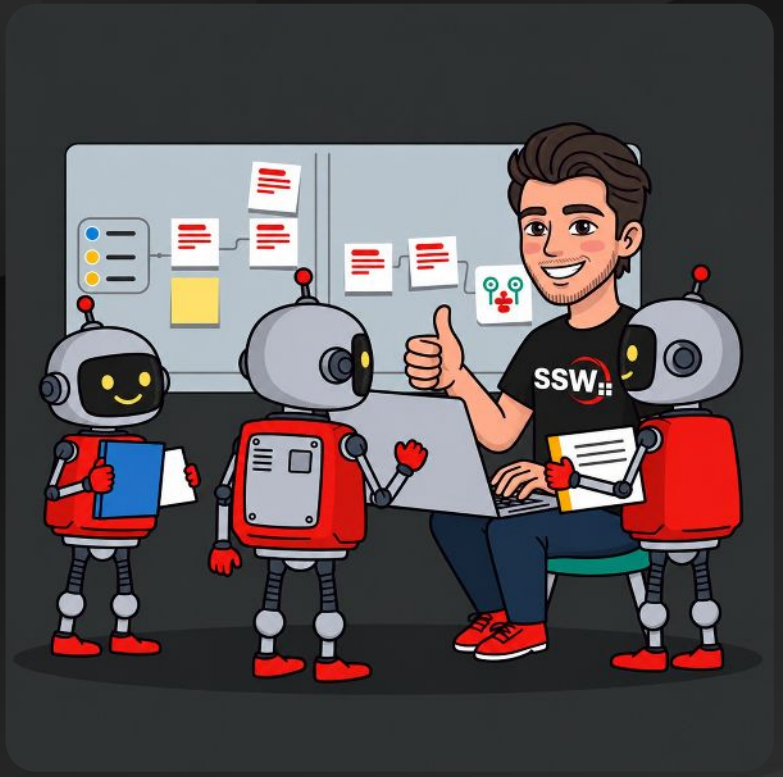


Illustration by Alex Blum

Eli Kent, SSW

SSW October User Group | Melbourne

The backlog before Agentic Workflows in tinacms



August: 300+ PBIs needing triage



This week: 9 PBIs needing triage

Images generated with FLUX.1

Kia ora, I’m Eli Kent



Scrum Master for TinaCMS at SSW

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Apps and Agents Developer Associate

GitHub Certified: GitHub Copilot

Skills: React, Next.js, .NET, Go, Azure, DevOps and TinaCMS

- From Invercargill, New Zealand
- Ice hockey, Jiu Jitsu and Muay Thai





Me, #71 for the Jets

Agents took over the boring work, so I have more time for the team.

40%

Boring work, done by agents

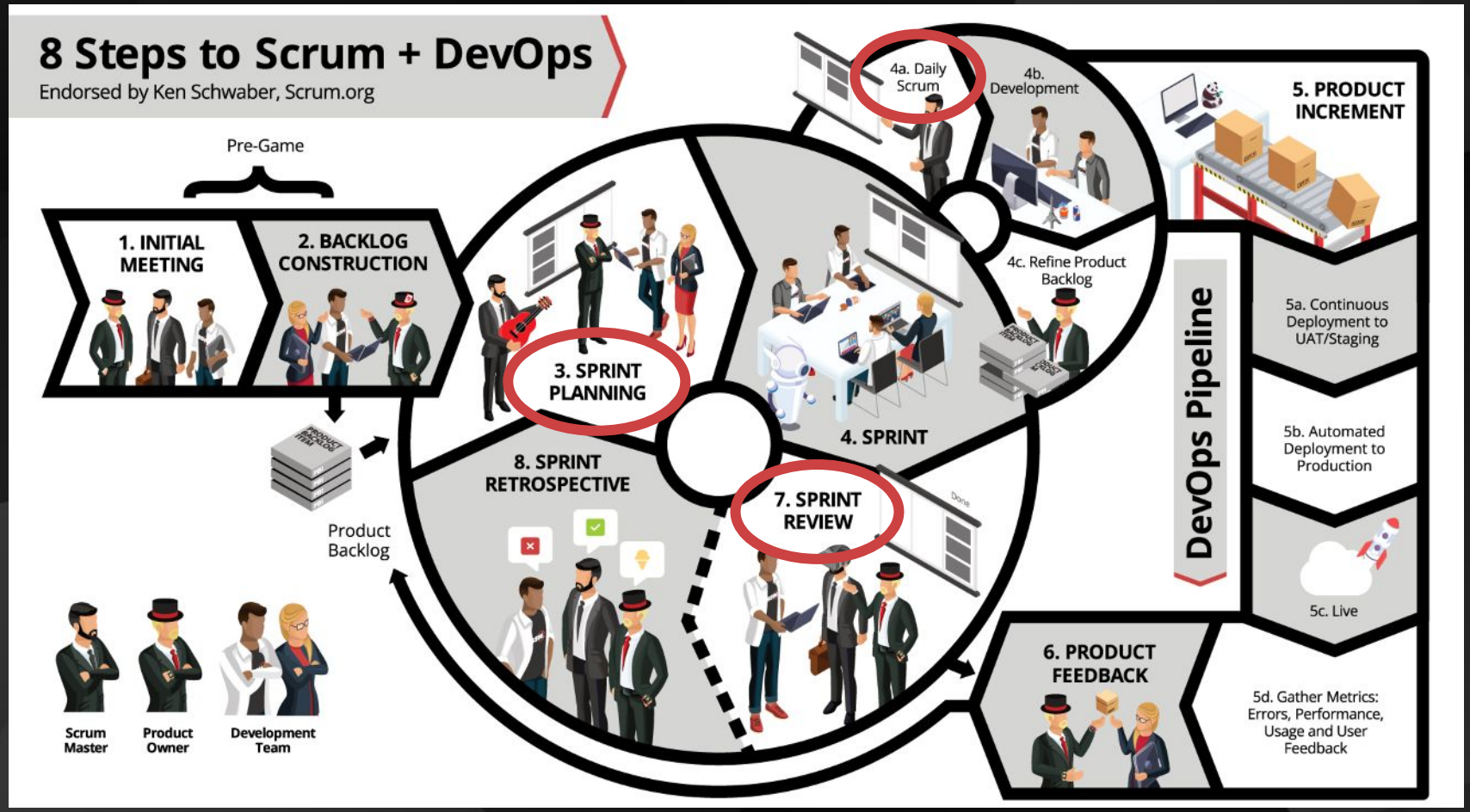
40%

Contributing work

20% 

Good yarns

The 8 Steps to Scrum



ssw.com.au/rules/8-steps-to-scrum

THE STEPS I OPTIMIZED

3. Sprint Planning

Agent proposes backlog changes

4a. Daily Scrum

Agent tells me what changed

7. Sprint Review

Agent drafts the email

My week, before agents

- ⚠️ Prepping the Sprint review and retro
- ⚠️ Chasing PBIs and updating the board
- ⚠️ Writing up what got done and what's next
- ⚠️ Triaging the same community question again
- ⚠️ Poking the same dashboards for the same problems



Agents do the busywork now.

I check their work. ✅



3 things make it work

1

Skills

Repeatable playbooks.
A skill is a markdown file.

2

Routines

A skill that runs on a schedule.

3

Connectors

MCP servers, CLIs and APIs into our tools.

The more an agent can edit, the closer I watch it.



- Read-only agents run safely overnight.
- Agents that write wait for my OK.

3 improvements to Scrum

	HELPS WITH	WHAT THE AGENT DOES	IMPACT	WHAT I DO
1	**Sprint Planning**	Agent proposes backlog changes	**Highest**	I accept
2	**Daily Scrum**	Agent tells me what changed	**Lowest**	I sleep
3	**Sprint Review**	Agent drafts the Sprint Review email	**Middle**	I edit

1 Sprint Planning with AI

Triaging, Refining and Acceptance

PBIs - Ready has a definition

SSW's Definition of Ready

Detail	Enough detail to action it, with acceptance criteria
Priority	Set by business value
Effort	In doubles: 2, 4, 8, 16

ssw.com.au/rules/have-a-definition-of-ready | *ssw.com.au/rules/add-business-value-with-ai-and-telemetry*

PBIs – Examples

Needs Triage

❌ A bad PBI

images not working

images broken again?? pls fix asap

Estimate	None
Priority	None

Backlog - Ready

✅ A good PBI

Bug - New uploads don’t show in the media manager until a refresh

Pain
Editors upload an image, don’t see it, and upload it again. The repo fills up with copies.

Acceptance criteria
- New uploads show without a refresh
- Uploading the same file twice asks before it saves a copy

Estimate	4
Priority	High



Who knows the difference between System 1 and System 2 models?

System 1: fast and automatic. Capital of France? Paris.

System 2: slow and deliberate. You reason it through.

From Daniel Kahneman, Thinking, Fast and Slow

ssw.com.au/rules/system-1-vs-system-2-ai

System 1 and System 2 models in tinacms

Jev scores each new PBI as it opens. Claude does the slow reading.

SYSTEM 1

Jev

TypeSafe AI, API in GitHub Actions

- Handles the agentic triage workflow
- Flags likely duplicates
- Picks a label (logged only, for now)
- Acts only when confident

SYSTEM 2

Opus & Sonnet

Anthropic, using Claude Code

- Handles the agentic refinement workflow
- Drafts the description, priority and estimate
- Shows its evidence
- I accept or skip each one

Daniel Kahneman, Thinking, Fast and Slow. *ssw.com.au/rules/system-1-vs-system-2-ai*

✕ Triaging - Before agentic workflows

These 2 questions came up on every PBI

IS IT A DUPLICATE?

Nearly 500 PBIs

I searched the open PBIs by hand for the same report.

WHAT AREA DOES IT TOUCH?

Area labels

I read each PBI and picked one: rich-text, media, form-system and more.

Now Jev checks both when a PBI opens.

✅ Triaging - After agentic workflow

- Jev picks up the new issues in GitHub Actions
- Action runs in 14s
- Gives candidates a score
- Picks form-system at 0.78

Triggered via issue 3 days ago	Status	Total duration	Artifacts
kulesy opened #7847 ea43628	Success	14s	–

Decision: add form-system; remove bug (dry run).

Question	Score
category: form-system	0.78
category: bug	0.19
category: editorial-workflow	0.02
onboarding	0.34
AI	0.23
(scope labels skipped: v4 program issue)	

The real run on tinacms, PBI #7847, 13 Oct 2026

✕ Refinement – Before agentic workflow

3 things I look for to meet the definition of ready



WHAT USERS SAY

Discord

The discussion behind the PBI.



WHAT USERS DO

PostHog

How many people use the feature, including the users who never post.



WHAT IT TOUCHES

The code

Which files change, and how much.

For every PBI, I had to check these all by hand

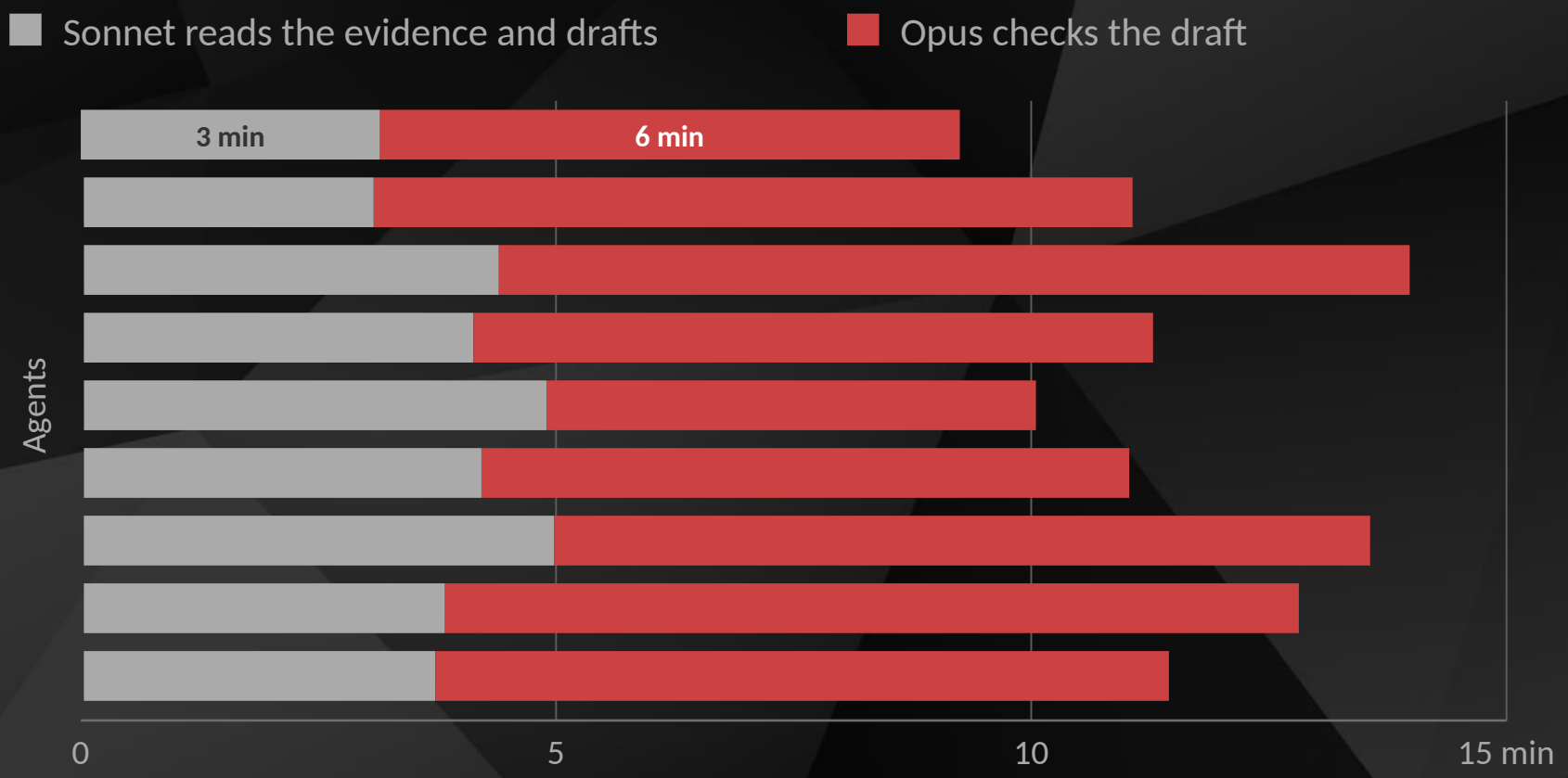
✅ Refinement - After agentic workflow

Claude Code now checks all of this for me.

- ✅ The detail
- ✅ The priority
- ✅ The effort

How Claude Code refines PBIs

Cheaper Sonnet drafts. Smarter Opus checks each draft before I see it.



9 min
for one batch of 17 PBIs

14 min
for all 146 PBIs at once

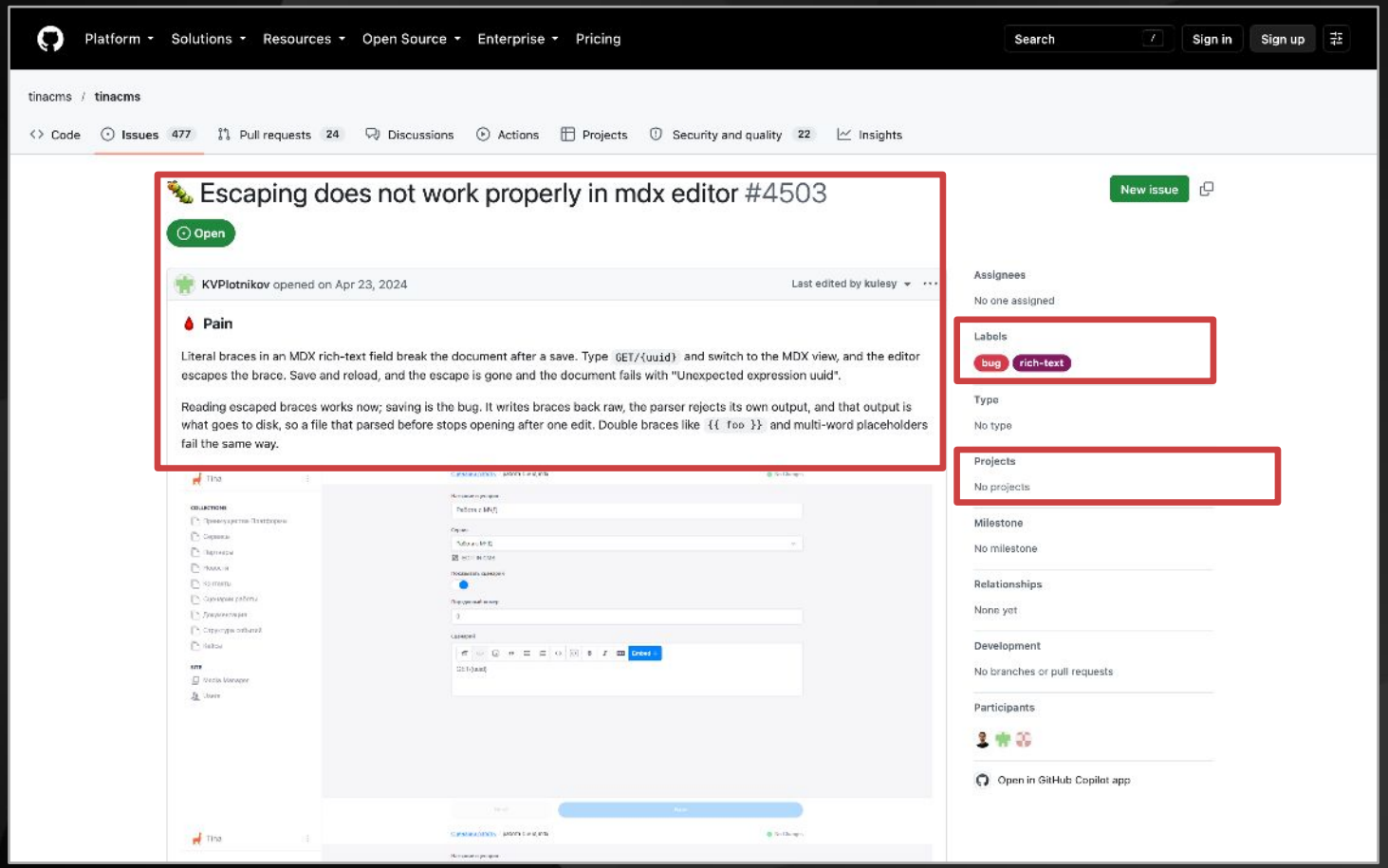
18
agents, two for each batch

Each row is one batch from my run on 14 Oct 2026, timed from the agents' logs.

Then I have to apply the agents' feedback

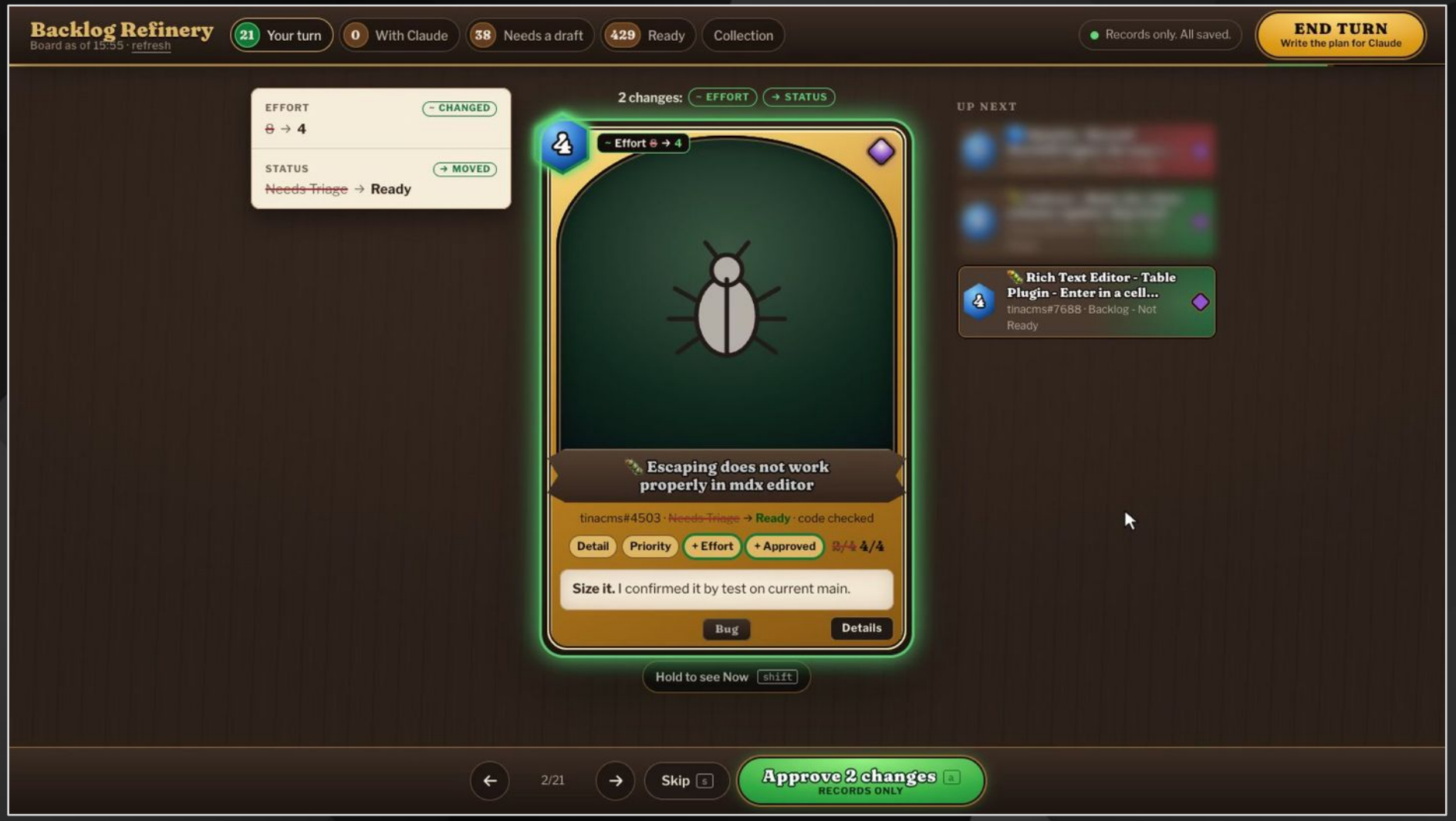
- Assign the label
- Edit the description
- Add the effort in GitHub Projects
- Set the priority

GitHub isn't built to review this in bulk,



tinacms PBI #4503 on GitHub, 16 Oct 2026

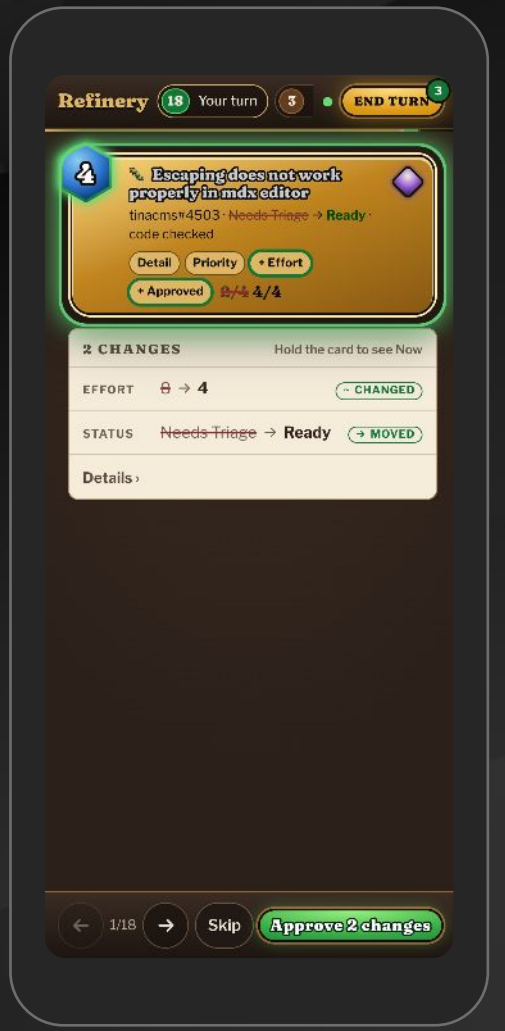
So I built an app for it – Backlog Refinery



It works from my phone

- It runs on my laptop. My phone reaches it over Tailscale.
- I triage the backlog from the couch.
- Then I ask Claude to apply what I accepted.

tailscale



2 Daily Scrum with AI

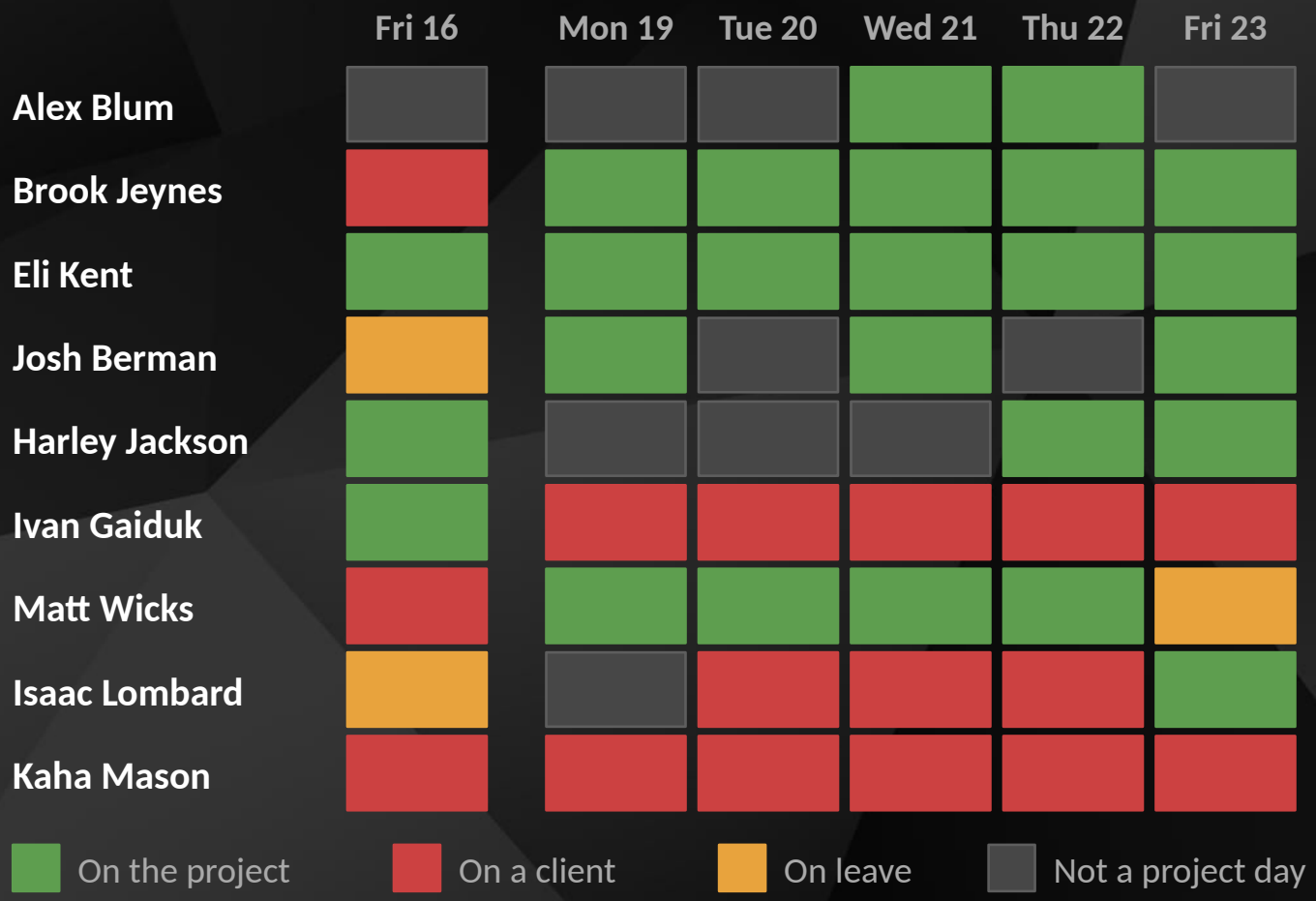
How my agent preps me for the Daily Scrum

The morning check

Every weekday morning, without me:

1. **The board**
   What moved and what stalled
2. **Reviews**
   PRs stuck in review
3. **The bench**
   Who is on leave or on a client
4. **CI**
   Red on main

Team member availability in a consulting firm



From the pulse, Fri 16 Oct 2026

- Each morning it reads bookings and leave from Power BI, through my Chrome.
- It knows each person's state holidays and part-time days.

How it helps during the Sprint

When someone comes off the project, it lists their work and who is free to take it.

CHANGES DURING THE SPRINT

Josh: 1 Tina day left, holds 28 pts

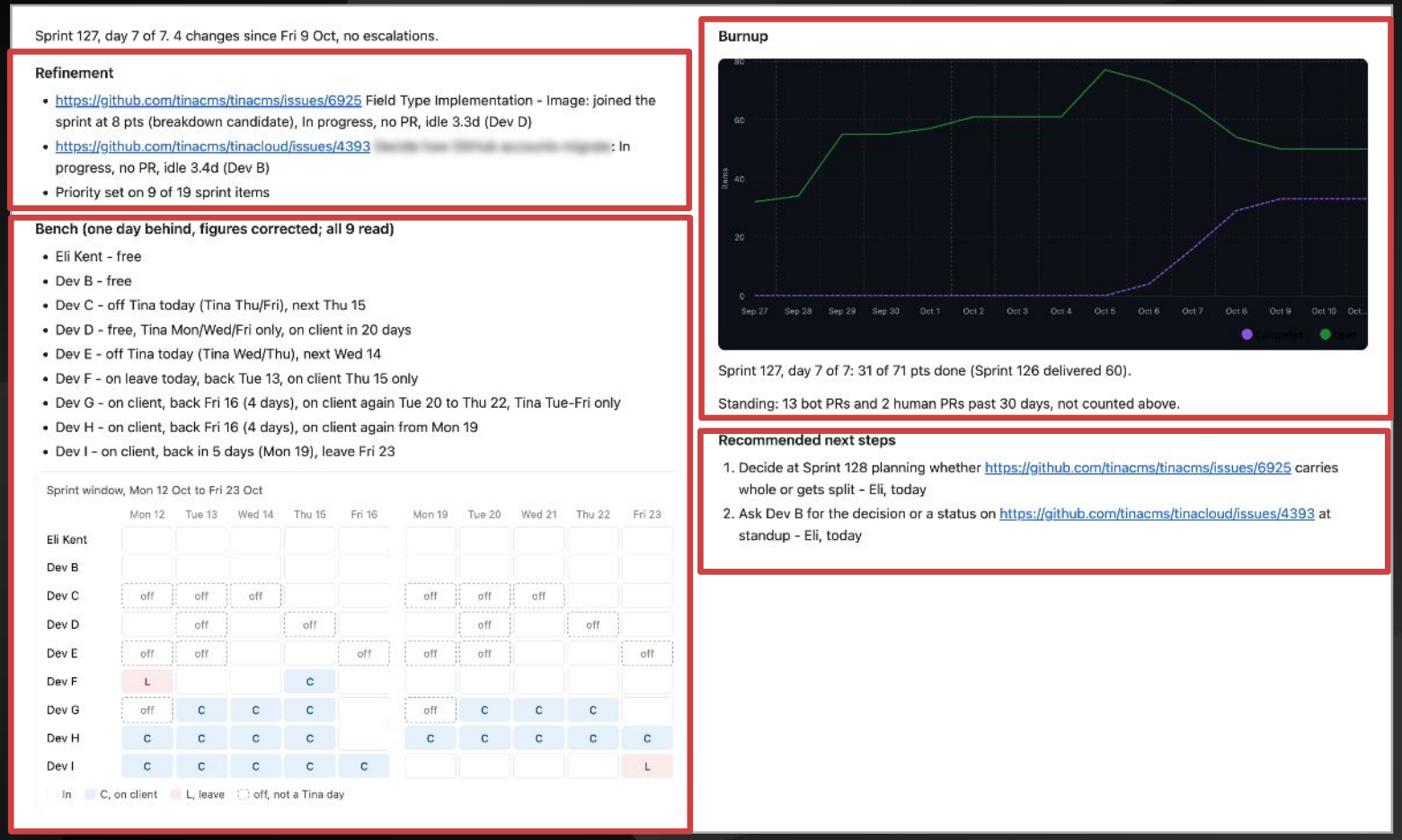
Plugin System - Content	In progress	**16**
Plugin System - Sidebar	In progress	**8**
Unsaved edits carry over	In progress	**2**
Text colors	In review	**2**

Free to take it: Eli Kent

From the pulse, Fri 16 Oct 2026

Sprint Pulse - the morning report

- Changes during the Sprint
- Team member availability
- Is the Sprint velocity tracking?
- What are the recommended next steps?



Sprint 127, day 7 of 7. 4 changes since Fri 9 Oct, no escalations.

Refinement

- https://github.com/tinacms/tinacms/issues/6925 Field Type Implementation - Image: joined the sprint at 8 pts (breakdown candidate), In progress, no PR, idle 3.3d (Dev D)
- https://github.com/tinacms/tinacloud/issues/4393 [redacted]: In progress, no PR, idle 3.4d (Dev B)
- Priority set on 9 of 19 sprint items

Bench (one day behind, figures corrected; all 9 read)

- Eli Kent - free
- Dev B - free
- Dev C - off Tina today (Tina Thu/Fri), next Thu 15
- Dev D - free, Tina Mon/Wed/Fri only, on client in 20 days
- Dev E - off Tina today (Tina Wed/Thu), next Wed 14
- Dev F - on leave today, back Tue 13, on client Thu 15 only
- Dev G - on client, back Fri 16 (4 days), on client again Tue 20 to Thu 22, Tina Tue-Fri only
- Dev H - on client, back Fri 16 (4 days), on client again from Mon 19
- Dev I - on client, back in 5 days (Mon 19), leave Fri 23

Sprint window, Mon 12 Oct to Fri 23 Oct

	Mon 12	Tue 13	Wed 14	Thu 15	Fri 16	Mon 19	Tue 20	Wed 21	Thu 22	Fri 23
Eli Kent										
Dev B										
Dev C	off	off	off			off	off	off		
Dev D		off		off			off		off	
Dev E	off	off			off	off	off			off
Dev F	L			C						
Dev G	off	C	C	C		off	C	C	C	
Dev H	C	C	C	C		C	C	C	C	C
Dev I	C	C	C	C	C					L

In · C, on client · L, leave · off, not a Tina day

Burnup

Sprint 127, day 7 of 7: 31 of 71 pts done (Sprint 126 delivered 60).

Standing: 13 bot PRs and 2 human PRs past 30 days, not counted above.

Recommended next steps

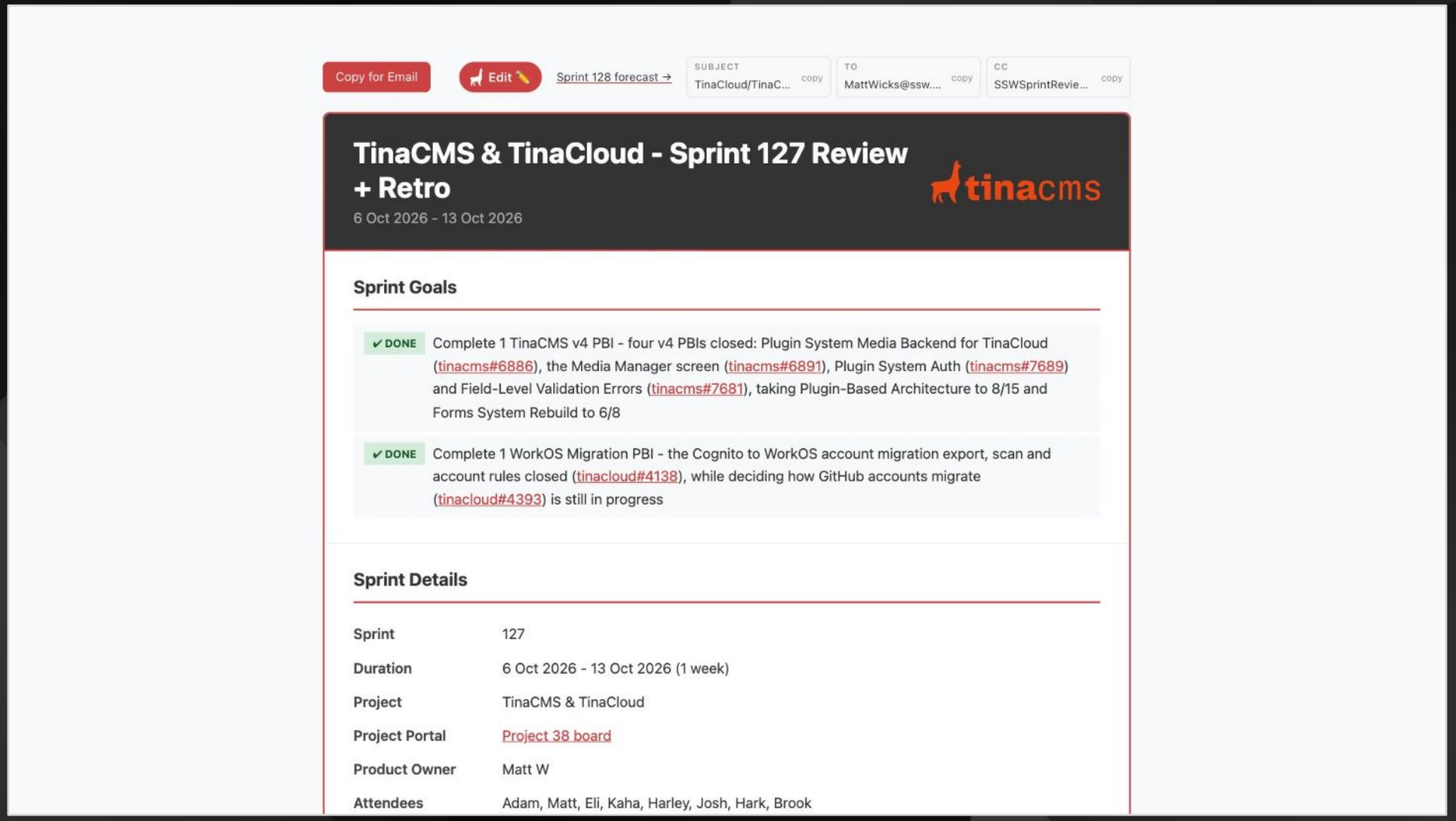
1. Decide at Sprint 128 planning whether https://github.com/tinacms/tinacms/issues/6925 carries whole or gets split - Eli, today
2. Ask Dev B for the decision or a status on https://github.com/tinacms/tinacloud/issues/4393 at standup - Eli, today

The pulse from Mon 12 Oct, names removed

3 Sprint Review with AI

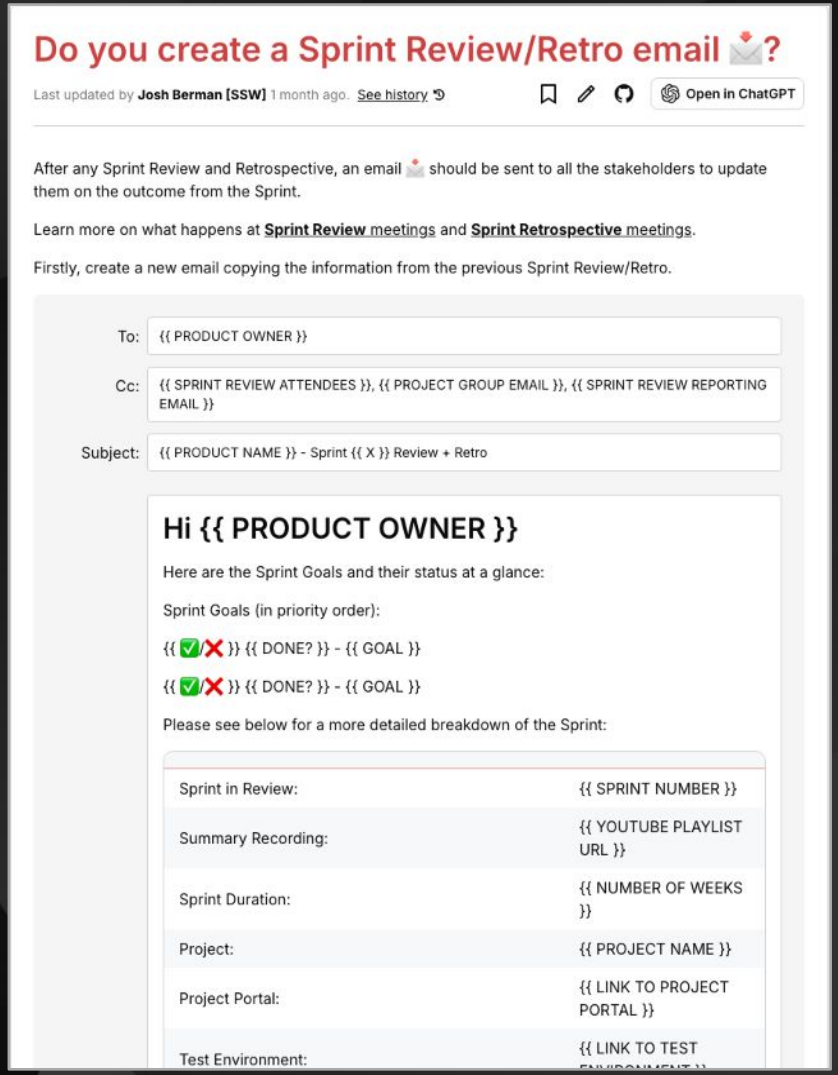
The routine that drafts documents ready to go

The Sprint Review email



SSW's rule for the Sprint Review email

- What information is required in the email
- How the layout of the email should look
- Who should be notified of the email (Product Owner, Stakeholders, etc...)



Do you create a Sprint Review/Retro email?

Last updated by **Josh Berman [SSW]** 1 month ago. See history

Open in ChatGPT

After any Sprint Review and Retrospective, an email should be sent to all the stakeholders to update them on the outcome from the Sprint.

Learn more on what happens at **Sprint Review** meetings and **Sprint Retrospective** meetings.

Firstly, create a new email copying the information from the previous Sprint Review/Retro.

To: {{ PRODUCT OWNER }}

Cc: {{ SPRINT REVIEW ATTENDEES }}, {{ PROJECT GROUP EMAIL }}, {{ SPRINT REVIEW REPORTING EMAIL }}

Subject: {{ PRODUCT NAME }} - Sprint {{ X }} Review + Retro

Hi {{ PRODUCT OWNER }}

Here are the Sprint Goals and their status at a glance:

Sprint Goals (in priority order):

{{ ✅/❌ }} {{ DONE? }} - {{ GOAL }}

{{ ✅/❌ }} {{ DONE? }} - {{ GOAL }}

Please see below for a more detailed breakdown of the Sprint:

Sprint in Review:	{{ SPRINT NUMBER }}
Summary Recording:	{{ YOUTUBE PLAYLIST URL }}
Sprint Duration:	{{ NUMBER OF WEEKS }}
Project:	{{ PROJECT NAME }}
Project Portal:	{{ LINK TO PROJECT PORTAL }}
Test Environment:	{{ LINK TO TEST

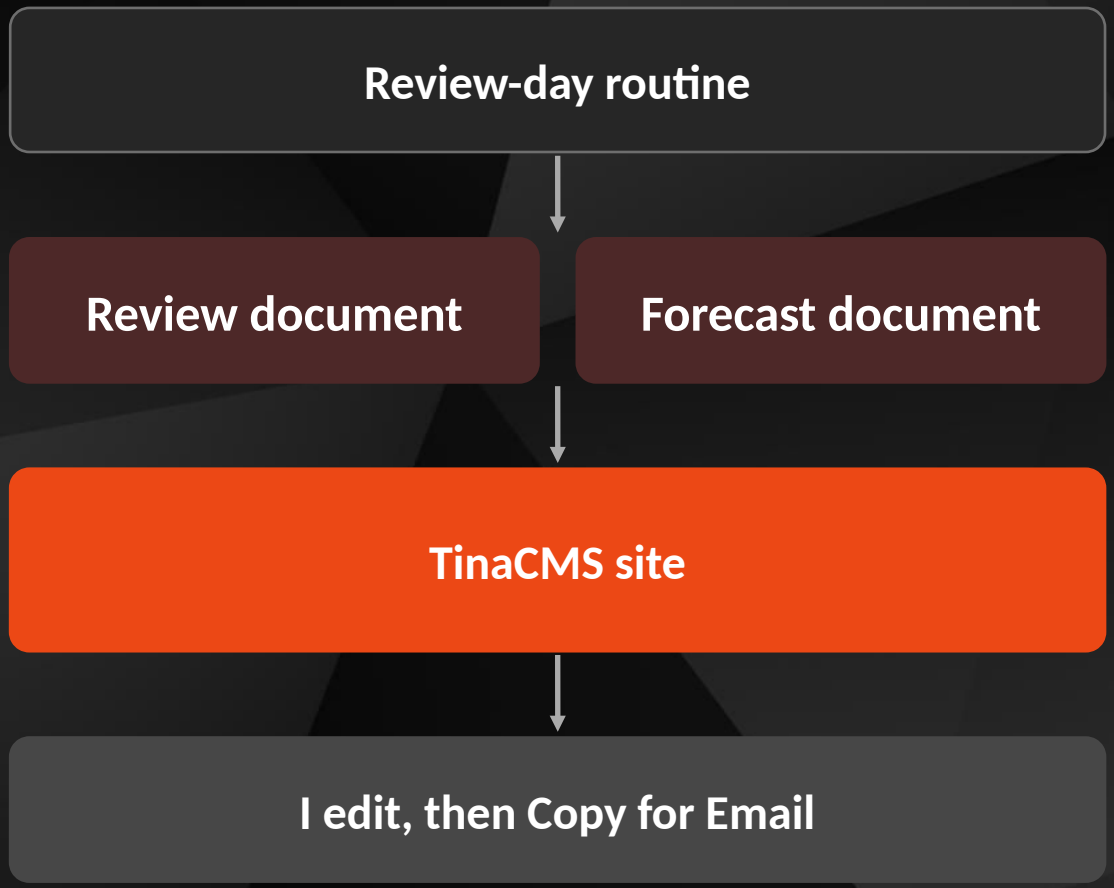
ssw.com.au/rules/sprint-review-retro-email

✗ Review day used to take all morning

1. Pull the numbers from six dashboards
2. Screenshot every chart
3. Write up what shipped and what's next
4. Format it twice: review and forecast

I did all of this by hand, every Sprint.

✅ Now a Claude Code agent writes everything



The tools behind the review page

On review day a Claude Code routine builds the page with three tools.

THE CHARTS



Claude in Chrome

Screenshots PostHog, Power BI, CloudWatch and GitHub charts in my signed-in Chrome.

THE BOARD



GitHub MCP/CLI

Pulls the Sprint's PBIs, estimates, PRs and releases.

THE PAGE



TinaCMS

I fill the gaps in the visual editor, then press Copy for Email.

Closing notes

TLDR; Agents do the boring work.

And I approve it for Scrum

Shout-out - SSW Tiger

We don't always notice how our meetings go

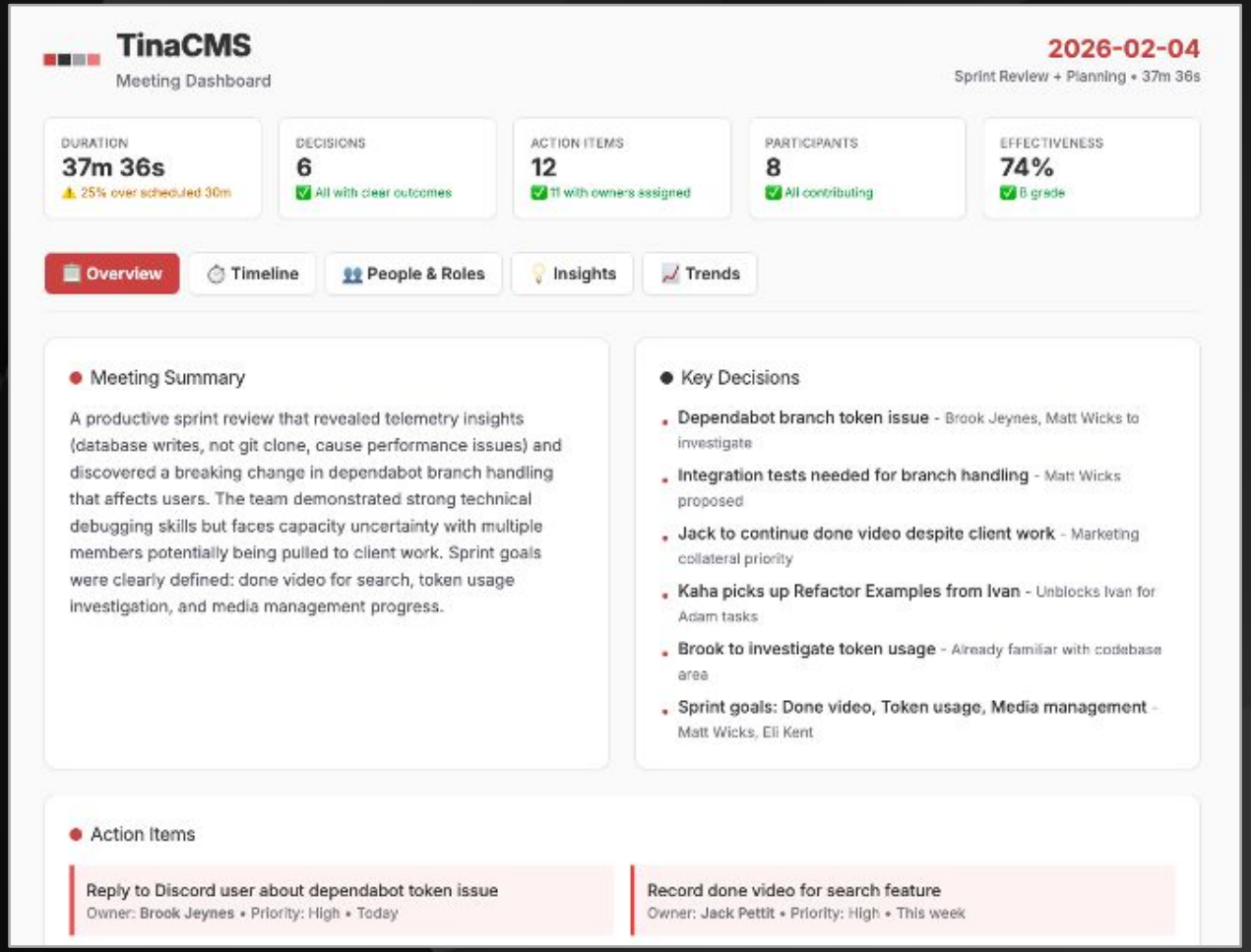
Timeline: who spoke, and when

People & Roles: each person's role, what they did well and what to work on

Trends: this meeting against past Sprints

sswtiger.com

Open source: github.com/SSWConsulting/SSW.Tiger



Example dashboard from the SSW.Tiger README

The future

Where I think Scrum is heading

PRODUCT OWNERS

Set the direction of the project

AI

Facilitates Scrum and keeps in line with the direction of the project

DEVELOPERS

Don’t have to worry about the Scrum routine, because it is fully automated.

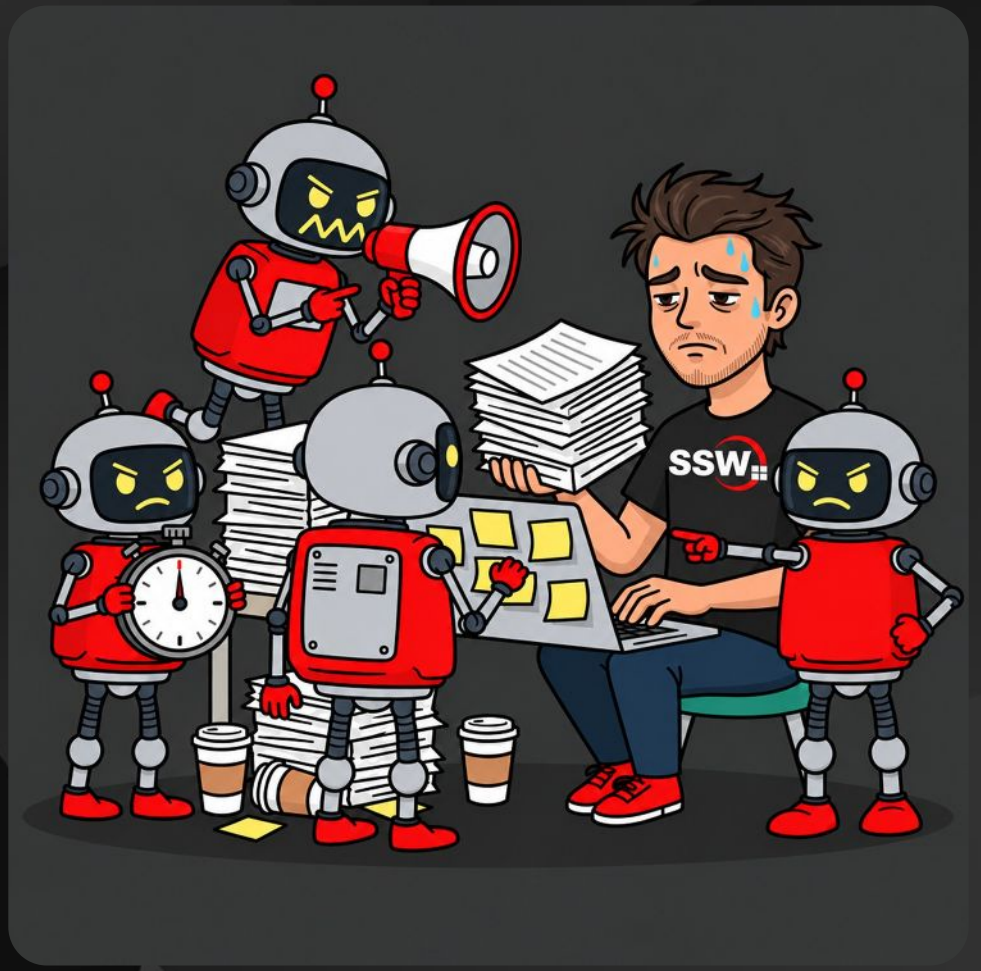


Illustration by Alex Blum

Summary

1

Sprint Planning with AI

Triaging, refining and approving PBIs with Jev, Claude Code and the Backlog Refinery

2

Daily Scrum with AI

Each morning it tells me who is on, what changed and the next steps.

3

Sprint Review with AI

It drafts the review in TinaCMS. I edit and send it.

Resources



The skills, Backlog Refinery and these slides.

github.com/kulesy/agentic-scrum-master-kit

Happy to keep talking afterwards.



info@ssw.com.au

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Sydney | Melbourne | Brisbane | Newcastle | China | France | USA

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Point your phone camera at the code.

